demonstrated the value of drones in delivering verified visual evidence during rapidly developing crises.

In addition to real-time live broadcasting, CNN has used drones extensively in investigative storytelling. UAVs have been deployed for environmental impact investigations, including pollution mapping, illegal mining monitoring, and coastal erosion documentation. In such cases, drone footage provided spatially and visually grounded evidence, strengthening the credibility of investigative findings and public accountability reporting (Niarchos, et al. 2022).

However, CNN's drone operations also underscore the importance of ethical and regulatory adherence in journalism. The network maintains strict compliance with FAA flight permissions, privacy protections, and newsroom editorial review protocols to ensure that aerial reporting does not intrude upon individuals or interfere with emergency operations. This illustrates how drones can be powerful journalistic tools when integrated responsibly, guided by clear professional standards and legal frameworks

8.10.11 Case study: National Geographic – wildlife documentaries and exploration filmmaking

National Geographic has been one of the most influential adopters of UAV technology for wildlife documentation, remote exploration, and environmental storytelling. Drone-based cinematography has enabled filmmakers and researchers to capture natural environments and animal behaviors that would otherwise be inaccessible due to geographical challenges, safety risks, or the need to avoid disrupting ecosystems. UAVs equipped with high-resolution, thermal, and multispectral cameras allow for silent, non-intrusive observation of wildlife habitats, enabling footage that combines scientific precision with visual artistry.